

Lesson Plan

Topic: Amazing Photographs

Teacher:	Ed Rush	Date:	21 June, 2026
Class:	M2/4A	Duration:	46 minutes
CEFR Level:	B1	Lesson Shape:	E (Receptive Skills (Traditional))
Materials:	• Oxford Discover Futures 2 Student Book pp. 38–39 • Oxford Discover Futures 2 Teacher's Guide pp. 60–61 • Afghan Girl photograph (Steve McCurry) • Audio track 1.10		
Slideshow URL:	https://elwrush.github.io/lesson-plan-writer/M24A-AMAZING-PHOTOGRAPHS/index.html		

Lesson Aim

Main aim: By the end of the lesson, learners will have practiced and developed the sub-skills of reading for the author's viewpoint and detail comprehension in the context of an article about the power of photographs.

Subsidiary aim: Learners will have learned and practiced compound adjectives (noun + present participle) and discussed their own opinions about photography.

= Lesson Stages

Lesson Stages

Time	Goal	Procedure	Int
STAGE 1: Lead-in – Afghan Girl			
5 min	To activate interest in the power of photographs through a famous, prize-winning image	• Display the Afghan Girl photograph on screen without giving any context • Ask: "What do you notice about this girl? How does she make you feel?" • Elicit a few responses, then reveal: "This photograph won every major prize in photography. It was taken by Steve McCurry in 1984 in a refugee camp in Pakistan." • Ask pairs to discuss: "Why do you think this photo is so famous? What makes it powerful?" • Brief whole-class feedback, then transition: "Today we're going to read	T-Ss → Pairs

Time	Goal	Procedure	Int
		about whether pictures still have power over us.”	
STAGE 2: Opinions about Photography			
5 min	To activate personal opinions about photography before reading	- Students open their books to p. 38. Read the four opinion pairs in Exercise 1 and choose the option that best matches their view - In pairs, students compare their choices and explain why - Whole-class feedback: take a quick poll for each pair (show of hands for a vs b) and discuss any strong disagreements - Read the Reading strategy box aloud: “Identifying an author’s viewpoint” - Check comprehension: “What does impartial mean? Why does it matter when we read?”	Indiv → Pairs → T-Ss
STAGE 3: Pre-teach Vocabulary			
4 min	To remove blocking vocabulary from the reading text so students can process the article more fluently	- Display each word on screen with its example sentence from the article (fragment reveal with audio where available): - Check comprehension with concept questions for each word:	T-Ss
STAGE 4: Reading for Viewpoint and Detail			
13 min	To identify the author’s viewpoint and find specific information in the article	- Exercise 2: Students read the article “Overexposure” on p. 39 and identify the author’s viewpoint for each of the four opinion pairs from Exercise 1 - Exercise 3: Play audio 1.10. Students read and listen, then answer the six comprehension questions individually	Indiv → Pairs → T-Ss
STAGE 5: Vocabulary – Compound Adjectives			
9 min	To understand and practise compound adjectives formed from a noun and a present participle	- Read the Discover vocabulary box on p. 38. Explain the pattern: noun + present participle = compound adjective (e.g., heart + breaking = heartbreaking) - Exercise 4: Students find the six compound adjectives in the article and match each one to a definition 1–6 - Exercise 5: Students rewrite four sentences by creating a compound adjective from the highlighted words	Indiv → Pairs → T-Ss
STAGE 6: Discussion – Talking Points			
7 min	To discuss and respond to the ideas in the article using personal opinions	- Display Exercise 6 questions on screen: - Students think individually for 1 minute, noting down ideas	Groups → T-Ss

Time	Goal	Procedure	Int
		- In small groups (3–4), students discuss both questions, using compound adjectives where possible - Groups share one interesting point from their discussion with the class - Teacher rounds off by returning to the Afghan Girl photo: “Do you remember this picture for more than a second?”	
STAGE 7: Wrap-up			
3 min	To consolidate key vocabulary and reflect on the lesson	- Quick vocab recall: T says a definition, students call out the compound adjective (e.g., “very sad” → heartbreaking, “visually stimulating” → eye-popping) - Ask 2–3 students: “What is one thing you’ll remember from today’s lesson?” - Preview: Next lesson – Discover grammar on p. 119	T-Ss

Answer Key

Answer Key – Amazing Photographs

Exercise 2: Identifying the author’s viewpoint

Item	Author’s viewpoint
1	a – Pictures can be very powerful
2	b – We see too many pictures
3	a – We prefer snapshots to serious photography
4	b – Images affect us less due to the media

Exercise 3: Read and listen

- The power to transport us to other places, the power to reach into our hearts and minds, the power to deceive us and make us buy things, the power to manipulate us.
- They can be extraordinary because they show amazing special effects, but they can become ordinary when we see them too often.
- They have very little impact on us.
- Because we see so many of them.
- Because we see so many of them, and we are under pressure to respond by “liking” them or commenting on them on social media.
- He/She thinks they are not very interesting or powerful.

Sidebar questions (suggested answers):

- Images at our fingertips:** We can see them at any time, with just the click of a button on our phones.
- Pictures in advertising/propaganda:** They can persuade us that we need something, or make us believe things that are not true.
- Blockbuster movie:** A movie with a lot of special effects, like car chases, fights, etc.
- “Bombardment”:** Suggests that things come toward us as if we are being attacked.

- **Author involves the reader:** By using the pronoun “we” and by asking the reader a question.

Exercise 4: Compound adjectives

Adjective	Definition
1. neverending	continue a long time
2. eye-popping	visually stimulating
3. breathtaking	with overpowering impact
4. heartbreaking	very sad
5. mind-numbing	very boring
6. thought-provoking	interesting

Exercise 5: Rewrite sentences

Item	Answer
1	It's a mouth-watering dish.
2	That story was heartwarming.
3	Those athletes are record-breaking.
4	That kind of shark is / can be man-eating.

Exercise 6: Talking points

Open discussion — no single correct answer.